

ACN: 2372074

Time / Day

Date : 202606

Place

Locale Reference.ATC Facility : PCT.TRACON

State Reference : VA

Person

Location Of Person.Facility : PCT.TRACON

Reporter Organization : Government

Function.Air Traffic Control : Approach

Qualification.Air Traffic Control : Fully Certified

Experience.Air Traffic Control.Time Certified In Pos 1 (yrs) : 4

ASRS Report Number.Accession Number : 2372074

Events

Anomaly.ATC Issue : All Types

Anomaly.Deviation / Discrepancy - Procedural : Published Material / Policy

Anomaly.Ground Event / Encounter : Ground Equipment Issue

Anomaly.Inflight Event / Encounter : Weather / Turbulence

Detector.Person : Air Traffic Control

When Detected : In-flight

Result.Air Traffic Control : Separated Traffic

Assessments

Contributing Factors / Situations : ATC Equipment / Nav Facility / Buildings

Primary Problem : ATC Equipment / Nav Facility / Buildings

Narrative: 1

I was working the ZZZZZ position, frequency 120.45, with a string of arrivals inbound to IAD on the GIBBZ5 Arrival, an unusual sequence due to weather near IAD. I went to issue a turn to Aircraft Y to the base leg and got no response. I tried again, no response. I reached out to two other aircraft with no response. I changed my transmitter to standby and tried again with no response. I plugged into the Emergency Communication System (ECS) orange box, still no response. My last chance was to plug back into the RDVS and attempt the tunable frequency which finally worked, though by then two aircraft had left my frequency.

Synopsis

PCT TRACON Controller reported losing all methods of communication with aircraft with little to no back-up options, and even after the frequency returned, the quality and coverage was less than ideal.